In part, this is because as Maclean has observed, although there is now at long last a discernible body of Bhagat Singh scholarship, this ‘curiously has had little impact in the Western academy’.[9] Indeed, ‘it is only relatively recently that scholarship has begun to position Bhagat Singh and the HSRA within a larger historical framework’. Even so, there has been remarkably little written on the trial itself with a few notable exceptions such as the path-breaking account of A.G. Noorani,[10] more than twenty years ago now, and more recently this writer’s own work on *The Trial of Bhagat Singh: Heresies of the Raj*, which has set out to redress that imbalance.[11] In fact, Christopher Pinney, describes it as ‘one of the puzzles of 20th-century Indian history that academics don’t seem to have engaged with’.[12] Bhagat Singh has truly been much neglected by historians.[13] For Pinney, it is extraordinary that the ‘official history has diverted so fundamentally from the popular narrative’. But it is precisely this neglect which has then so enhanced the popular image of Bhagat Singh as a heroic and chivalrous figure in the struggle for independent India like no other.